

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 3 2

♥ Q 8 3

♦ 10 9 6

♣ A Q 3

♠ A K 7 5

♥ K J 7

♦ A 8 3

♣ 9 8 2



♠ 10 8 4

♥ 6 5 4 2

♦ K Q J 4

♣ 7 5

♠ Q 6

♥ A 10 9

♦ 7 5 2

♣ K J 10 6 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Win with dummy's ♠Q and force out the ♣A.

The rest of the tricks are yours, nine in all.

If West had only held 2 ♦s it would have been OK to hold up your ♦A just once.

But with this layout you needed to hold up twice.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 6

You will need some ♣ tricks to make the contract. If East has 5 ♦s and also the ♣A then you will go down. It doesn't matter if he has the ♣Q because you can finesse him out of that.

But in the case where West has both the ♣ A Q you need to make sure he has no ♦ when he takes his first trick. So hold up the ♦A until the third round, everybody following.

Now start on the ♣s. Play your ♣9 and let it ride. West wins the ♣Q and returns a ♠. Good, he didn't have the fourth ♦.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 8 2
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 6 4
♣ A 9 5

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 9

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ Q 10 4



♠ J 10 9 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A K 9
♣ K 7 6

♠ 6

♥ A 10 8 6 4

♦ 10 7 3

♣ J 8 3 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

You have lost two tricks so far. Lead the ♠J and let it ride. North wins their third trick with the ♠K but has no ♥ to return so he plays a ♦ which you win with your ♦A.

Play off your 7 winners and give up a ♣ at the end.

The K Q x holding is similar to the A J x holding. It might be two stoppers, or might just be one, depending on which defender next leads the suit.

So you decide whether to hold up or not based on how you expect to play the hand.

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution West chooses not to bother with Stayman. East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♥6. North plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if South takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if North takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into North you should hold up.

North returns the ♥9, South takes the ♥A and clears the suit.